

Creative & Critical Paradigm Shifts in Environment &

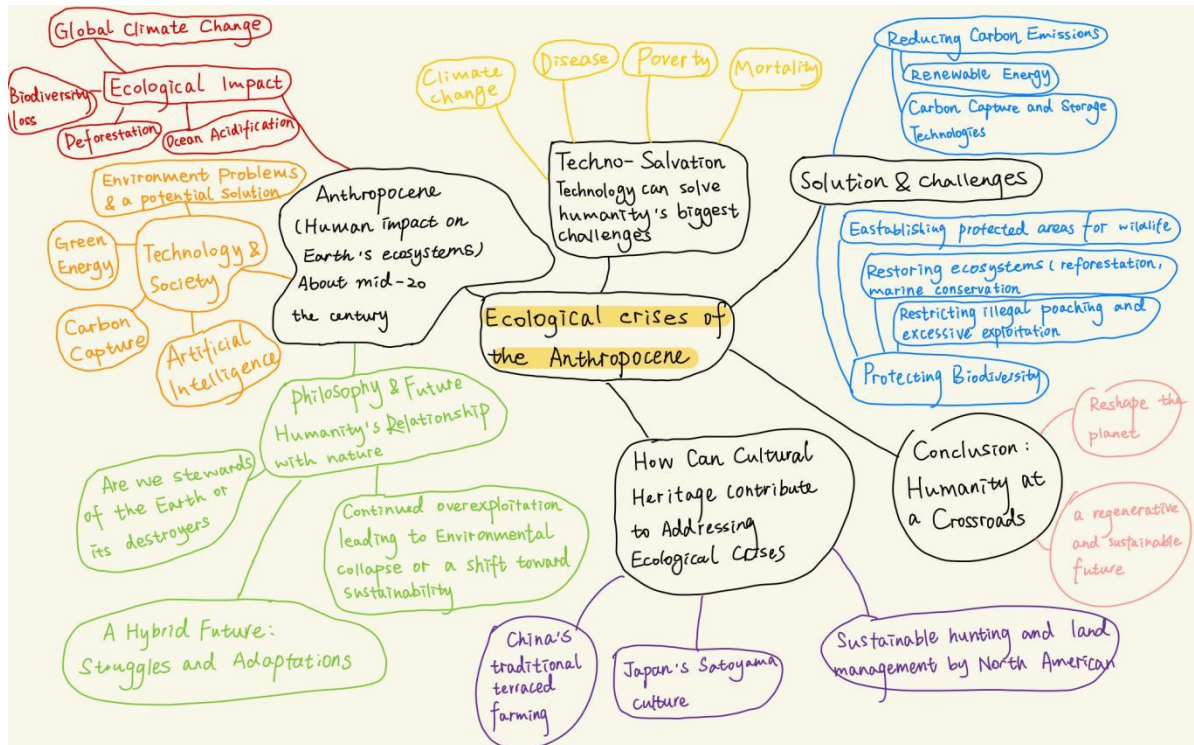
Week Four: A1 Process Journal Activities and Forum Space

1. Critical Thinking Activity

- We also did some brainstorming related to the topic in class and created mind maps. From the explanations in the lecture and the subsequent VR experience, I gained a lot of inspiration regarding the subject of this chapter. Nature and religion have always been highly interconnected. Nature and Religion: An Inseparable Connection Nature and religion have always been inseparable. Across different cultures and belief systems, nature is not only regarded as the environment for human survival but is also often imbued with sacred significance, serving as a source of reverence, worship, and spiritual experience.
- The following are several cross-cultural stories that illustrate the deep connection between nature and religion. Buddha and the Bodhi Tree: A Revelation of Wisdom. In Buddhist tradition, the Bodhi Tree holds profound sacred significance. According to legend, Gautama Buddha meditated beneath a Bodhi Tree in Bodhi Gaya, India, and ultimately attained enlightenment there. As a result, this tree became a powerful symbol in the Buddhist world, representing wisdom and spiritual awakening.
- This is just one example. Similar concepts can also be found in Christianity, as well as in the Chinese myths of Pangu creating the world and Nuwa creating

humans. Since ancient times, humans have recognized their dependence on nature.

2. Creative Practice Activity



Reference

Borde, Radhika, editor.; Ormsby, Alison A., editor.; Awoyemi, Stephen

M.2023.Religion and Nature Conservation : global case studies.Abington, Oxon ;

New York, NY : Routledge

Week Seven: A1 Process Journal Activities

- Critical Themes

1. Social Research in Museum Practices:

- Museums have a unique role in shaping public understanding of climate change, and social research is a powerful tool they can use to ensure they're doing it in a way that resonates with and includes diverse communities, so we argue that the museum should be a key convener of discussions around climate change. (Hamilton, P. and Christian Ronning, E., 2020.)Museums and science centers hold a unique position in the media and political landscape as trusted information sources and are emerging as key players in climate change debates. (Cameron, F., Hodge, B. and Salazar, J.F., 2013.) Museums can use the approach that: audience mapping & demographics museums conduct surveys, focus groups, and community outreach to understand who their audiences are — and who is missing. This includes collecting data on age, ethnicity, socioeconomic background, geographic location, education levels, etc. For example, research may reveal that indigenous voices are underrepresented in climate narratives, even though these communities are disproportionately affected by environmental change. They can use the way of diverse storytelling curators can incorporate a wider range of narratives. Indigenous knowledge systems, migrant experiences, urban vs rural perspectives, rather than defaulting to a dominant (often Western, white, middle-class) lens.

- Museums carry an old reputation of being temples of knowledge.(Chaudhary, P. and Singh, N., 2024.) In order to actively foster spaces for dialogue on climate change that invite reflection and action, they can co-curation with communities. For example, museums can invite local communities, especially those directly affected by climate change, to co-curate exhibitions—sharing their stories, cultural knowledge, and environmental practices, and local communities showcasing traditional ecological knowledge, or youth activists contributing artwork or social media campaigns.

2. Role of Emotions in Knowledge Systems:

- I think emotion is a kind of “communication” with ourselves or others. Climate change is not just a scientific or political issue — it's deeply personal and existential. And for the issue of climate change nowadays, I think may be it is hard to hold a completely positive attitude towards it. And for the long term beliefs or behaviour, emotional connection can re-frame the identity: climate concern becomes part of how someone sees themselves.

Creative Themes

3. Museum Design and Engagement:

- I think “action stations” is great. people walk out of an exhibit and straight into an action lab—with QR codes for petitions, voter registration stations, sustainable business directories, even a pledge wall. Knowledge is great—but activation is better. Museums can do so in many ways. For example, systems thinking exhibits. they are supposed to show how climate is tied to food, housing, fashion,

inequality—make the connections visible and tangible. Also, they can build up a community co-creation by letting visitors shape part of the exhibition. Let neighborhoods contribute local climate data or cultural responses.

- The can achieve the goal in different ways. First one: making space for emotional Engagement. creative works allow space for feelings—grief, anxiety, hope—in a way that pure information can't. This is crucial in climate communication, because many people are emotionally blocked or overwhelmed by the crisis. This emotional processing can be a first step toward real behavioral change — when people feel seen and connected, they're more likely to act.

References:

Cameron, F., Hodge, B. and Salazar, J.F., 2013. Representing climate change in museum space and places. *Wiley Interdisciplinary Reviews: Climate Change*, 4(1), pp.9-21.

Chaudhary, P. and Singh, N., 2024. A Virtual Museum Experience in Fiji. *Girmitiya Culture and Memory: Navigating Identity, Tradition, and Resilience Across Continents*, p.241.

Hamilton, P. and Christian Ronning, E., 2020. Why museums? Museums as conveners on climate change. *Journal of Museum Education*, 45(1), pp.16-27.

Week Nine: A1 Process Journal Activities

(Due to the length of my main text, if I include everything, it will exceed the word limit. However, please forgive me as I believe this section is highly relevant to our course content and is the result of my reading and summarization. Furthermore, this section is also closely related to my A3 project. After much thought, I decided to include this excerpt. Thank you for your understanding. None of the words enclosed in these parentheses are counted towards the total word count.)

Vermander, B., 2019. Myth, nature and society in China. *Jeevadhara. A Journal for Socio-Religious Research*, XLIX, pp.63-75.

- Myth and History in Different Cultures: The status and interpretation of mythology vary across civilizations, with some cultures (like ancient Greece and India) giving myth a prominent role in their worldview, while others (like Rome and China) prioritize history. In these latter societies, history became the foundation for national identity and morality, often overshadowing mythology.
- Chinese Mythology and Its Transformation: Early Chinese mythology was rich, but Confucian thought shifted the focus towards historical narratives and moral teachings. While myths still appear in texts like the *Book of Odes* and *Zhuangzi*, the Confucian influence minimized their importance, aiming to create a cohesive historical record for social and individual harmony.
- Agricultural Myths and Cultural Heroes: Chinese myths are deeply tied to agriculture, with figures like Shennong (the farmer god) and Houji (Lord Millet) playing crucial roles in the development of farming practices. These myths

emphasize the connection between agriculture, ritual, and social order, illustrating how myths support both spiritual and practical aspects of early Chinese civilization.

- This article made me reflect on how myths and history are intertwined in different cultures and how they shape societal identity and morals. In particular, Chinese mythology, despite the Confucian shift, continues to play a significant role in agriculture and social order, showing the close connection between myth and everyday life.

- 2. Creative Process: Influences & Inspiration

(1)Podcast: AUTO Radio No.20200510—World mythology: humanity was born from imagination.

This is a highly popular podcast show in China. Each episode revolves around a specific theme and features 2 to 7 hosts or guest speakers. Based on their own understanding and the materials they've prepared in advance, they engage in diverse discussions around the same topic.



(2)Book:Mythologies of all races

The Mythology of All Races is a classic 13-volume series on mythology, published between 1916 and 1932. Each volume is rich in content, covering mythological stories, deities, religious rituals, and symbolic meanings, and includes detailed illustrations and annotations. This book will become one of my primary sources of information and reference.

